



BONA VIA

Bona Via — User Guide

iPhone and Apple Watch · on foot and by bicycle

What Bona Via is

Bona via — “good way”, in Latin — is the blessing given to anyone setting out on pilgrimage. The app walks with you from the first step to the destination: it measures distance along the official route, shows how much is left, keeps your family informed and preserves the memory of your journey.

Everything that matters works **without internet**: the routes, the elevation profiles and the places to sleep and eat are stored inside the app.

Before you leave: create the journey

On the first screen, tap **New journey**.

- Choose the **route** — Francés, Primitivo, Portuguese Central or Coastal, Fisterra and Muxía, Inglés, Caminho da Fé — or “Other / free route” to make your own.
- Say whether you go **on foot or by bicycle**, the start date and the expected arrival.
- You can leave your **pace** blank: the app learns it from your first stages. If you prefer, set your speed and comfortable daily distance now.
- If the arrival date is tight for the distance, the app says so and suggests another one.

Each morning: today's destination

Tap **Choose today's destination**. The app starts from where you are.

- It **suggests** places within your comfortable distance, marked ✓, and shows with ⚠ the ones beyond it. You can also search for any place by name.
- Before you start, the screen shows the **distance**, the **estimated time** (which already includes the effort of the climbs), the **day's weather** with the warnings that matter, and **what to take** — water, snacks, sunscreen, rain cover, warm layer, torch.
- Tap **Start stage** when you set foot on the road.

Walking

The screen shows the map with your track, how much is **left**, the **expected arrival time**, how far you have **walked** and your **pace**.

- **Pause** keeps stopped time out of the count: use it at lunch and at visits. **Finish** closes the stage and stores it in your journey.
- The stage **survives closing the app** and restarting the phone. If you forget to finish it, it is still there when you come back.

When the signal is gone

Out on the way, and abroad without data, Apple's map turns grey. Tap the **Offline map** button: the app draws its own map, with the trail, what you have walked, your position, the destination and the places nearby.

It needs nothing downloaded on the spot — it is all on the phone.

On the Apple Watch

During a stage the watch shows how much is left, the arrival time, the time and pace, and the direction of the destination.

- You can **pause, resume and finish** from your wrist, without taking the iPhone out of your pocket.
- The watch reminds you to **drink water** and suggests a **rest** when you have been moving for a long time or your heart rate stays high.
- On the first stage, allow "Workouts" and "Heart rate" when the watch asks — that is what keeps the app alive on screen while you walk.

Safety

In the **Safety** tab, add your **contacts** (straight from your address book) and your **medical card**: blood type, allergies, medication, health plan.

- **SOS** counts five seconds, prepares the message with your location for your contacts, and shows the emergency numbers of the country you are in.
- **What SOS does not do:** for safety reasons, Apple does not let any app call or send a message without a tap from you. Bona Via prepares everything; the last tap is yours.
- Apple's own **Emergency SOS** (side button + volume on iPhone, side button on the Watch) and the watch's **Fall Detection** do call emergency services by themselves. It is worth checking they are on before you leave.
- Turn on the warnings for **running late**, for being **stopped** too long, and for **low battery**.

Your family follows along

In **Safety**, turn on *Notify my family* and write your name. An **8-letter code** appears.

- Whoever stays home installs Bona Via on an iPhone or iPad, taps *I only want to follow someone* and types the code. That is all — from then on they receive it on their own.
- They see where you are on the map, the day's destination, how much is left and the expected time, and they get a message when you **set out, arrive, run late**, stay **stopped** or trigger **SOS**.
- Following covers the **whole journey**, not only while you walk: at the albergue, on a rest day and between stages, the people at home keep hearing from you.
- To stop, just switch it off. What was on the server is erased.

Other pilgrims

If you want to, turn on the **community** and choose a nickname. You see who is heading for the same destination today, on foot or by bicycle.

Nobody sees your location — only the day's destination. You can block and report anyone who bothers you.

After the stage

When you finish, the **day's summary** opens by itself: the map of what you walked, the times, the distance, the moving time, the pace, the climb, the weather and that day's photos.

- The **album** keeps each photo with the place where it was taken. The **journey map** shows the whole pilgrimage, each day in its own colour, and can be shared as an image.
- Finished pilgrimages are kept in **History**.

The golden rule

The yellow arrow is in charge, not the line on the map. The stone markers count the kilometres to Santiago, and those are what you trust.

The app's route is there to measure and to place you — never to replace the waymarking. This app was made so that you look at the screen as little as possible.

Help

Write to mariosouza@mac.com. I answer personally.

In an emergency, do not wait for email: tap SOS in the app or call the emergency number of the country you are in.